09-04 第一篇

The Science of Honey Bees

Honey bees are among the most fascinating and important creatures on Earth. They live in highly organized colonies, each with a queen, workers, and drones. Every bee has a specific job, and together they keep the colony alive and productive. [1] Understanding how honey bees work is not just interesting—it is essential, because these tiny insects play a huge role in our food supply.

Bees are vital pollinators. As they move from flower to flower collecting nectar, they carry pollen that helps plants reproduce. Without bee pollination, many of the fruits, vegetables, and nuts we eat would not exist. [2] In fact, experts estimate that one out of every three bites of food we eat depends on pollination by bees and other insects.

Inside the hive, bees communicate in remarkable ways. They perform a "waggle dance" to tell other bees where to find food. [3] This complex communication system allows the colony to share information quickly and work together efficiently, ensuring that every bee knows exactly where to go.

In recent years, bee populations have been declining around the world. Pesticides, habitat loss, disease, and climate change all threaten their survival. [4] Scientists warn that if bee numbers continue to fall, the consequences for agriculture and ecosystems could be severe.

What can we do to help? Planting bee-friendly flowers, avoiding harmful pesticides, and supporting local beekeepers are all simple steps. [5] Protecting honey bees is not just about saving one species—it is about preserving the delicate balance of nature that supports all life, including our own.

选项

A. The remarkable social structure of a bee colony is one of nature's most impressive examples of teamwork. B. This makes bees not just producers of honey, but critical partners in growing the food the world needs. C. By dancing in different patterns and speeds, a bee can communicate distance, direction, and quality of a food source. D. These combined threats have led to what scientists call "colony collapse disorder," a crisis that demands urgent attention. E. Every effort to support bee health contributes to a healthier environment and a more secure food future for all. F. For example, almonds in California depend almost entirely on honey bees brought in from across the country.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前描述蜂群的组织结构（蜂后、工蜂、雄蜂各有分工），空后说理解蜜蜂的运作方式很重要。A的"remarkable social structure"承接前文组织描述，"one of nature's most impressive examples of teamwork"概括协作特点。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说没有蜜蜂授粉，许多果蔬坚果将不存在，空后说每三口食物就有一口依赖蜜蜂。B的"not just producers of honey, but critical partners in growing food"概括蜜蜂对农业的关键作用，承上启下。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说蜜蜂通过"摇摆舞"告诉同伴食物位置，空后说这套复杂通讯系统让蜂群高效协作。C的"dancing in different patterns and speeds"具体解释舞蹈方式，"communicate distance, direction, and quality"详述信息内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前列举蜜蜂面临的威胁（农药、栖息地丧失、疾病、气候变化），空后说如果蜜蜂数量继续下降后果严重。D的"These combined threats"概括前文多重威胁，"colony collapse disorder"引出紧迫的危机。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前列举帮助蜜蜂的方法（种花、避免农药、支持蜂农），空后说保护蜜蜂是保护自然平衡。E的"Every effort to support bee health"承接前文行动，"healthier environment and a more secure food future"升华主题。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, almonds in California depend almost entirely on honey bees brought in from across the country.**：以For example开头，属具体农作物案例；易误放[2]，但[2]需的是蜜蜂农业作用的概括，非单一作物案例。